

Lesson 14:

What is a Dashboard?

A **dashboard** is a visual tool that consolidates key information (e.g., KPIs) on a single screen to facilitate easy monitoring and quick decision-making.

Why Do Different Dashboard Types Exist?

Dashboards are tailored to different audiences (executives, analysts, operators) based on factors such as time sensitivity, interactivity, and the types of decisions that need to be supported.

Characteristics of Dashboards

1. **Visual Summarization:** Condenses complex data into easy-to-understand visuals for quick comprehension.
 2. **Single-Screen Display:** Ensures all information is visible on one screen without the need to scroll or click.
 3. **Real-Time or Near Real-Time:** Dashboards should display data in real-time or near real-time for quick responses to anomalies.
 4. **Customization & Interactivity:** Allows users to filter data and create role-based views tailored to their needs.
 5. **Contextual Relevance:** Data presented should be directly relevant to the user's goals and objectives.
 6. **Visual Design Principles:** Utilizes pre-attentive attributes (e.g., color, size, position) and clear layout to guide the user's attention and make data easy to understand.
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Additional Resources

- **Example:** [Greenhouse Gas Emissions Data \(IMF\)](#)
- **Additional IMF Data:** [NGDP Growth Rates by Country](#)